

- How do these Money Stories differ from my Money Story as an adult? What Money Stories do I hold today?
- What Money Stories have I rejected as an adult and what Money Stories did I keep?
- Who is the voice in my head when I think about money or what I believe about money? Is that voice pleasant, helpful, curious, judgemental, critical or even unkind?

If you're struggling to understand what your Money Story is, you might try some different financial awareness exercises that I covered in more detail in my book *Unf*ck Your Finances*. I've given you some examples below to guide you:

- When it comes to money, what attributes do I believe are good, what do I believe are bad, and what do I believe are okay? (For example, you might believe it's good to buy your own home or that all debt is bad.)
- If money was a person, how would I describe my relationship with it? (For example, is it a loving relationship, is it illicit and obsessive like an ex-lover that you can't stop thinking about, or is it potentially shameful and humiliating like a drunk uncle who you know will embarrass you in real life or online?)
- What are my wealth creation values? Are these values reflected in how I am spending and investing? If not, why not?

Recognising, understanding and even being tired of your Money Story or reacting emotionally to it positively or negatively are good things but they're only the first step.

The final and vital questions to ask are:

- Is that Money Story serving or sabotaging me?
- What Money Stories do I want to keep and what do I want to reject? In other words, what adapted Money Story do I want to write?

As you start to think about rewriting your Money Story, I want to return to the work of Dr Brené Brown. In her book *Rising Strong*, Brené